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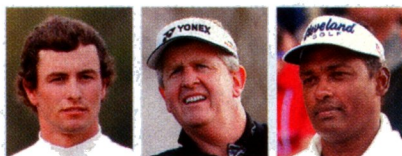
Kyi Hla Han said he regards India as a "giant" in Asian golf.

Giants are difficult to miss particularly when they come attached to large numbers like India does. Business is hardwired into golf's DNA, and the interest in India and its market since the turn of the century has materialised in the European Tour turning up at our doorsteps. Thirty per cent of the European Tour's events are held outside Europe which Keith Waters, the Tour's director of international policy, says is due to two major factors: winter weather and "a drive from the sponsors" to go to new markets.

The confluence of the hyper-marketed, micro-managed European Tour and the somnolent DGC made for an entertaining clash of civilisations. A European Tour event is a travelling circus but cannot afford to look like one. The DGC in turn had to put its ritual circus on hold to host European pros. One section of the club's 9-hole 'B' course was converted into the area for tempo-

COMING SOON

Following the Indian Masters, India will host its second European Tour event, the Johnnie Walker Classic at Gurgaon's DLF Golf and Country Club from February 28. The Johnnie Walker Classic travels over Asia and Australia and its first visit to India will



Scott, Montgomerie, Singh feature golf's established veterans like Vijay Singh and Colin Montgomerie along with Australia's world No 7 Adam Scott, flamboyant Englishman Ian Poulter, and the cigar-smoking Spaniard Miguel Angel Jimenez. The event will offer prize money of \$2.57 million with the winner taking home \$429,708.

SUPPORT: Crowds followed pros like Frenchman Raphael Jacquelin

rary structures to house tournament offices. Organisers Golf In Dubai needed 350 persons to run the event, including security, scorers and 100 men from the Assam Rifles to police barriers. An 80-member television crew and 14 cameras on buggies produced the event footage. Detailing went down to menu approvals in the players lounge and finding working room for the travelling Tour meteorologist.

Out on the greens, there was more. Modern courses today are high on yardage and acreage to accommodate modern driver technology and occupy vast tracts of countryside outside cities. The DGC, dotted with Lodi dynasty burial tombs, sits in the heart of Delhi, a stone's throw from a railway station. Short on yardage by conventional standards, the DGC's narrow fairways are lined thick with merciless shot-swallowing trees. Touring Irish pro Graeme McDowell said, "It's a golf course you can't overpower at all... it tests the mind rather than the biceps."

As the pros lined up to make putts, there was a good chance that their grim contemplation would be interrupted by a snarling opera of car horns bursting forth over a boundary wall. Or, equally, that a wandering peacock would have